

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12383361
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Itkowitz; Brandon D. et al.

Layered functionality for a user input mechanism in a computer-assisted surgical system

Abstract

A computer-assisted surgical system is configured to activate a first mode of operation in which movement of a user control mechanism is translated to movement of a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm; receive, during the first mode of operation, a first user input by way of a user input mechanism associated with the user control mechanism; activate, based on the first user input, a second mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is repositionable without causing the surgical instrument to move; receive, during the first mode of operation, a second user input by way of the user input mechanism, wherein the second user input is different from the first user input; and activate, based on the second user input, a function associated with a third mode of operation different from the first and second modes of operation.

Inventors: Itkowitz; Brandon D. (San Jose, CA), Bedard; Adrian N. (Campbell, CA)

Applicant: Intuitive Surgical Operations, Inc. (Sunnyvale, CA)

Family ID: 72428061

Assignee: Intuitive Surgical Operations, Inc. (Sunnyvale, CA)

Appl. No.: 18/675783

Filed: May 28, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240307142 A1	Sep. 19, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17438055 US 12016646 WO PCT/US2019/021948 20190312 child-doc US 18675783

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G06F17/00** (20190101); **A61B34/00** (20160101); **A61B34/20** (20160101); **A61B90/00** (20160101); **G06F3/01** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B34/74** (20160201); **A61B34/20** (20160201); **A61B90/37** (20160201); **G06F3/011** (20130101); A61B2090/373 (20160201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61B (34/74); A61B (34/20); A61B (90/37); A61B (2090/373); A61B (34/25); A61B (2034/741); A61B (2090/061); A61B (34/70); A61B (34/35); G06F (3/011)

USPC: 606/1

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
8004229	12/2010	Nowlin et al.	N/A	N/A
9386983	12/2015	Swensgard et al.	N/A	N/A
9517106	12/2015	Hourtash et al.	N/A	N/A
9579088	12/2016	Farritor et al.	N/A	N/A
10617479	12/2019	Itkowitz	N/A	A61B 90/37
11389171	12/2021	Goldsmith	N/A	N/A
11419687	12/2021	Itkowitz et al.	N/A	N/A
11424027	12/2021	Shelton, IV	N/A	N/A
11510741	12/2021	Shelton, IV et al.	N/A	N/A
11730550	12/2022	Itkowitz	606/130	A61B 34/30
11747895	12/2022	Zhao	715/771	G06F 3/04815
11877816	12/2023	Goswami	N/A	A61B 90/39
11992283	12/2023	Itkowitz	N/A	A61B 1/3132
12016646	12/2023	Itkowitz	N/A	A61B 34/20
12035978	12/2023	Buil et al.	N/A	N/A
12164684	12/2023	Itkowitz	N/A	G16H 20/40
2006/0167440	12/2005	Cooper et al.	N/A	N/A
2006/0276686	12/2005	Tsuji et al.	N/A	N/A
2009/0088775	12/2008	Swarup et al.	N/A	N/A
2009/0163948	12/2008	Sunaoshi et al.	N/A	N/A
2010/0174410	12/2009	Greer et al.	N/A	N/A
2010/0234857	12/2009	Itkowitz et al.	N/A	N/A
2011/0118752	12/2010	Itkowitz et al.	N/A	N/A
2011/0118753	12/2010	Itkowitz et al.	N/A	N/A
2012/0179169	12/2011	Swarup et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0024024	12/2012	Namiki	N/A	N/A
2013/0211590	12/2012	Diolaiti et al.	N/A	N/A

2013/0303892	12/2012	Zhao et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0345718	12/2012	Crawford et al.	N/A	N/A
2016/0100898	12/2015	Jinno et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0129108	12/2016	Diolaiti et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0280076	12/2017	Trees et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0280099	12/2017	Cone et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0015851	12/2021	Itkowitz et al.	N/A	N/A
2024/0261048	12/2023	Payyavula	N/A	A61B 34/35
2024/0296608	12/2023	Itkowitz	N/A	A61B 34/30
2024/0325098	12/2023	Itkowitz	N/A	A61B 34/35
2024/0358462	12/2023	Griffiths	N/A	A61B 34/20

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
101876386	12/2017	KR	N/A
WO-2012151585	12/2011	WO	N/A
WO-2018216501	12/2017	WO	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Accurate Parameter Estimation for Master-Slave Operation of a Surgical Robot (Year: 2021). cited by examiner

Extended European Search Report for Application No. EP20190919306, mailed on Oct. 11, 2022, 10 pages. cited by applicant

He C., et al., "Research and Realization of a Master-slave Robotic System for Retinal Vascular Bypass Surgery," Chinese Journal of Mechanical Engineering, Aug. 2018, vol. 31(78), pp. 1-10. cited by applicant

International Preliminary Report on Patentability for Application No. PCT/US2019/021948, mailed on Sep. 23, 2021, 7 pages. cited by applicant

International Search Report and Written Opinion for Application No. PCT/US2019/021948, mailed on Dec. 10, 2019, 12 pages. cited by applicant

Setchi R.M., et al., "Reconfigurability and Reconfigurable Manufacturing Systems: State-of-the-art Review," 2nd IEEE International Conference on Industrial Informatics, 2004, pp. 529-535. cited by applicant

Shi H., et al., "Accurate Parameter Estimation for Master-slave Operation of a Surgical Robot," Machines, 2021, vol. 9, pp. 1-18. cited by applicant

Vertut, J., and Coiffet, P., "Robot Technology: Teleoperation and Robotics Evolution and Development," English translation, Prentice-Hall, Inc., Englewood Cliffs, NJ, USA 1986, vol. 3A, 332 pages. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Mancho; Ronnie M

Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent Ser. No. 17/438,055, filed Sep. 10, 2021, which is a U.S. National Stage Application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/US2019/021948, filed Mar. 12, 2019, each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

(1) A computer-assisted surgical system allows a surgeon to control telemanipulated surgical instruments to perform a surgical procedure on a patient. The surgeon uses master controls of the computer-assisted surgical system to control movement of the surgical instruments to perform the surgical procedure.

(2) The computer-assisted surgical system may have user input mechanisms (e.g., buttons or the like) through which the surgeon can control additional functionality of the computer-assisted surgical system, such as user input mechanisms for selecting functions of the computer-assisted surgical system to be performed. It is desirable that such user input mechanisms are intuitive and convenient for the surgeon to use and do not impede or overly complicate operation of the master controls of the computer-assisted surgical system.

SUMMARY

(3) An exemplary system includes a processor and a memory storing instructions and a processor communicatively coupled to the memory and configured to execute the instructions to detect an actuation and a de-actuation of a user input mechanism associated with a user control mechanism for controlling a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system, the user input mechanism configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is decoupled from controlling the surgical instrument, determine, based on the detecting of the actuation and the de-actuation of the user input mechanism, information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism, compare the information to a set of defined criteria, and perform, when the information satisfies the set of defined criteria, a function associated with a different mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system.

(4) An exemplary non-transitory computer-readable medium stores instructions that, when executed, direct at least one processor of a computing device to detect a first input received by way of a user input mechanism associated with a user control mechanism for controlling a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system, the user input mechanism configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is decoupled from controlling the surgical instrument, determine, based on the detecting of the first input, a first set of information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism, detect a second input received by way of the user input mechanism, determine, based on the detecting of the second input, a second set of information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism, compare the first set of information and the second set of information to a set of defined criteria, and perform, when the set of defined criteria is satisfied, a function associated with a different mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system.

(5) An exemplary method includes detecting an actuation and a de-actuation of a user input mechanism associated with a user control mechanism for controlling a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system, the user input mechanism configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is decoupled from controlling the surgical instrument, determining, based on the detecting of the actuation and the de-actuation of the user input mechanism, information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism, comparing the information to a set of defined criteria and performing, when the information satisfies the set of defined criteria, a function associated with a different mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings illustrate various embodiments and are a part of the specification. The illustrated embodiments are merely examples and do not limit the scope of the disclosure. Throughout the drawings, identical or similar reference numbers designate identical or similar elements.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary computer-assisted surgical system according to principles described herein.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates an exemplary control system that may be included within the computer-assisted surgical system of FIG. 1 according to principles described herein.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates an exemplary function selection system according to principles described herein.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary method for selectively performing a function of a computer-assisted surgical system according to principles described herein.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates an exemplary method for selectively performing a function of a computer-assisted surgical system according to principles described herein.

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates an exemplary computing system according to principles described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Systems and methods for providing layered functionality for a user input mechanism of a computer-assisted surgical system are described herein. Based on the layered functionality of the user input mechanism, a user of the computer-assisted surgical system may intuitively and/or efficiently select functions of the computer-assisted surgical system to be performed. In certain implementations, for example, the computer-assisted surgical system may include a control mechanism, such as a set of one or more master controls, through which a surgeon may provide input to telemanipulate a surgical instrument that is coupled to the control mechanism. The computer-assisted surgical system may further include a user input mechanism associated with (e.g., situated on) the control mechanism and through which a surgeon may provide input to indicate one or more layered functions mapped to the user input mechanism to be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system. In certain examples, the computer-assisted surgical system may be configured to process input received by way of the user input mechanism, as well as information associated with the input (e.g., contextual information such as information about movement of the control mechanism that is associated with the input), to determine which of the various layered functions to perform. The computer-assisted surgical system may be configured to process the input and associated information in a manner that supports use of a single user input mechanism, such as a single, binary-option user input mechanism, for user selection of any of multiple layered functions mapped to the user input mechanism that are to be performed.

(9) As an example, the computer-assisted surgical system may provide a normal mode of operation in which a control mechanism such as a set of master controls may be manipulated by a surgeon to telemanipulate a surgical instrument that is coupled to a manipulator arm of the computer-assisted surgical system. The computer-assisted surgical system may also provide a clutch mode of operation in which the master controls are decoupled from manipulating the surgical instrument such that the surgeon may manipulate (e.g., reposition) the master controls without affecting the surgical instrument (e.g., without moving or otherwise telemanipulating the surgical instrument). The computer-assisted surgical system may include a user input mechanism configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation. In addition to facilitating activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation, the user input mechanism may be configured to facilitate user selection of one or more additional functions to be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system.

(10) The user input mechanism may be a single, binary-option user input mechanism associated with a control mechanism such as a set of master controls. To illustrate one example, the user input

mechanism may be a button situated on a control mechanism such as a set of master controls. The computer-assisted surgical system may be configured such that the surgeon can choose to operate computer-assisted surgical system in the clutch mode operation by actuating and holding the button (e.g., by pressing the button and holding it down) while the surgeon manipulates the master controls. The same button may also be used by the surgeon to indicate another function of the computer-assisted surgical system to be performed. For example, a momentary actuation and de-actuation of the button that satisfies a set of defined criteria, such as a quick click of the button that satisfies the criteria, may be mapped to another function of the computer-assisted surgical system such that a momentary actuation and de-actuation of the button that satisfies the defined criteria will trigger a performance of the function.

(11) To this end, the computer-assisted surgical system may receive information associated with user interactions with the button (e.g., pressing, releasing, holding), as well as information associated with the master controls (e.g., position, movement, velocity), and determine whether the user interactions with the button satisfy the defined criteria, which may indicate whether the surgeon intended to indicate another function of the computer-assisted surgical system to be performed, such as a function associated with another mode of operation different from the clutch mode of operation. Additionally, such information can be used by the system to determine if an interaction with the button was unintentional.

(12) By accessing and using additional information associated with the user input mechanism and the master controls, the computer-assisted surgical system may reliably and/or accurately select and perform one or more functions of the computer-assisted surgical system that the surgeon intended to be performed. Further, by processing the received input using additional information as described herein, the computer-assisted surgical system may allow a surgeon to activate various modes of operation and/or initiate performance of various functions associated with different modes of operation using the same input mechanism, which may allow for fewer and/or more useful user input mechanisms and a simple and uncluttered interface that is intuitive to use. Intuitive interfaces may allow a surgeon to perform fewer unintended actions and/or perform intended actions more easily, which may result in convenient and/or intuitive operation of the computer-assisted surgical system, as well as more efficient surgical procedures. This may allow the computer-assisted surgical system to have a compact and flexible mechanical design (e.g., a design that allows multiple degrees of motion for hands of a surgeon manipulating master controls) and may help keep to a minimum the number of user input mechanisms that are implemented by the computer-assisted surgical system. These and other advantages and benefits of the systems and methods described herein will be made apparent.

(13) FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary computer-assisted surgical system **100** (“surgical system **100**”). As shown, surgical system **100** may include a manipulating system **102**, a user control system **104**, and an auxiliary system **106** communicatively coupled one to another. Surgical system **100** may be utilized by a surgical team to perform a computer-assisted surgical procedure on a patient **108**. As shown, the surgical team may include a surgeon **110-1**, an assistant **110-2**, a nurse **110-3**, and an anesthesiologist **110-4**, all of whom may be collectively referred to as “surgical team members **110**.” Additional or alternative surgical team members may be present during a surgical session as may serve a particular implementation.

(14) While FIG. 1 illustrates an ongoing minimally invasive surgical procedure, it will be understood that surgical system **100** may similarly be used to perform open surgical procedures or other types of surgical procedures that may similarly benefit from the accuracy and convenience of surgical system **100**. Additionally, it will be understood that the surgical session throughout which surgical system **100** may be employed may not only include an operative phase of a surgical procedure, as is illustrated in FIG. 1, but may also include preoperative, postoperative, and/or other suitable phases of the surgical procedure. A surgical procedure may include any procedure in which manual and/or instrumental techniques are used on a patient to investigate or treat a physical

condition of the patient.

(15) As shown in FIG. 1, manipulating system **102** may include a plurality of manipulator arms **112** (e.g., manipulator arms **112-1** through **112-4**) to which a plurality of surgical instruments may be coupled. Each surgical instrument may be implemented by any suitable surgical tool (e.g., a tool having tissue-interaction functions), medical tool, imaging device (e.g., an endoscope), sensing instrument (e.g., a force-sensing surgical instrument), diagnostic instrument, or the like that may be used for a computer-assisted surgical procedure on patient **108** (e.g., by being at least partially inserted into patient **108** and manipulated to perform a computer-assisted surgical procedure on patient **108**). While manipulating system **102** is depicted and described herein as including four manipulator arms **112**, it will be recognized that manipulating system **102** may include only a single manipulator arm **112** or any other number of manipulator arms as may serve a particular implementation.

(16) Manipulator arms **112** and/or surgical instruments attached to manipulator arms **112** may include one or more displacement transducers, orientational sensors, and/or positional sensors used to generate raw (i.e., uncorrected) kinematics information. One or more components of surgical system **100** may be configured to use the kinematics information to track (e.g., determine positions of) and/or control the surgical instruments.

(17) User control system **104** may be configured to facilitate control by surgeon **110-1** of manipulator arms **112** and surgical instruments attached to manipulator arms **112**. For example, surgeon **110-1** may interact with user control system **104** to remotely move or telemanipulate manipulator arms **112** and the surgical instruments. To this end, user control system **104** may provide surgeon **110-1** with imagery (e.g., high-definition 3D imagery) of a surgical area associated with patient **108** as captured by an imaging system (e.g., an endoscope or any other suitable medical imaging system). In certain examples, user control system **104** may include a stereo viewer having two displays where stereoscopic images of a surgical area associated with patient **108** and generated by a stereoscopic imaging system may be viewed by surgeon **110-1**. Surgeon **110-1** may utilize the imagery to perform one or more procedures with one or more surgical instruments attached to manipulator arms **112**.

(18) To facilitate control of surgical instruments, user control system **104** may include a control mechanism such as a set of master controls. The master controls may be manipulated by surgeon **110-1** to control movement of surgical instruments (e.g., by utilizing robotic and/or teleoperation technology). The master controls may be configured to detect a wide variety of hand, wrist, and finger movements by surgeon **110-1**. In this manner, surgeon **110-1** may intuitively perform a procedure using one or more surgical instruments.

(19) Auxiliary system **106** may include one or more computing devices configured to perform primary processing operations of surgical system **100**. In such configurations, the one or more computing devices included in auxiliary system **106** may control and/or coordinate operations performed by various other components (e.g., manipulating system **102** and user control system **104**) of surgical system **100**. For example, a computing device included in user control system **104** may transmit instructions to manipulating system **102** by way of the one or more computing devices included in auxiliary system **106**. As another example, auxiliary system **106** may receive, from manipulating system **102**, and process image data representative of imagery captured by an imaging device attached to one of manipulator arms **112**.

(20) In some examples, auxiliary system **106** may be configured to present visual content to surgical team members **110** who may not have access to the images provided to surgeon **110-1** at user control system **104**. To this end, auxiliary system **106** may include a display monitor **114** configured to display one or more user interfaces, such as images (e.g., 2D images) of the surgical area, information associated with patient **108** and/or the surgical procedure, and/or any other visual content as may serve a particular implementation. For example, display monitor **114** may display images of the surgical area together with additional content (e.g., graphical content, contextual

information, etc.) concurrently displayed with the images. In some embodiments, display monitor **114** is implemented by a touchscreen display with which surgical team members **110** may interact (e.g., by way of touch gestures) to provide user input to surgical system **100**.

(21) Manipulating system **102**, user control system **104**, and auxiliary system **106** may be communicatively coupled one to another in any suitable manner. For example, as shown in FIG. 1, manipulating system **102**, user control system **104**, and auxiliary system **106** may be communicatively coupled by way of control lines **116**, which may represent any wired or wireless communication link as may serve a particular implementation. To this end, manipulating system **102**, user control system **104**, and auxiliary system **106** may each include one or more wired or wireless communication interfaces, such as one or more local area network interfaces, Wi-Fi network interfaces, cellular interfaces, etc.

(22) In some examples, a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions may be provided in accordance with the principles described herein. The instructions, when executed by a processor of a computing device, may direct the processor and/or computing device to perform one or more operations, including one or more of the operations described herein. Such instructions may be stored and/or transmitted using any of a variety of known computer-readable media. Such a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions may be implemented by one or more components of surgical system **100**.

(23) A non-transitory computer-readable medium as referred to herein may include any non-transitory storage medium that participates in providing data (e.g., instructions) that may be read and/or executed by a computing device (e.g., by a processor of a computing device). For example, a non-transitory computer-readable medium may include, but is not limited to, any combination of non-volatile storage media and/or volatile storage media. Exemplary non-volatile storage media include, but are not limited to, read-only memory, flash memory, a solid-state drive, a magnetic storage device (e.g. a hard disk, a floppy disk, magnetic tape, etc.), ferroelectric random-access memory (“RAM”), and an optical disc (e.g., a compact disc, a digital video disc, a Blu-ray disc, etc.). Exemplary volatile storage media include, but are not limited to, RAM (e.g., dynamic RAM).

(24) FIG. 2 illustrates an exemplary control system **200** communicatively coupled to a user control mechanism **202** and a manipulator arm **112**. Control system **200** may be communicatively coupled to user control mechanism **202** and manipulator arm **112** in any suitable way that allows data, communications, and/or other signals to be sent by control system **200** to user control mechanism **202** and manipulator arm **112** and/or to be received by control system **200** from user control mechanism **202** and manipulator arm **112**.

(25) Control system **200** may be implemented within one or more components of surgical system **100**, such as within user control system **104**, auxiliary system **106**, manipulating system **102**, or any combination thereof. Control system **200** may be implemented as hardware, software, or a combination of hardware and software configured to perform one or more of the operations described herein, including operations for processing user input received by way of user control mechanism **202** and determining operations of surgical system **100** based on the user input. For example, control system **200** may be configured to translate movements of user control mechanism **202** into movements of manipulator arm **112** and/or a surgical instrument **204** attached to manipulator arm **112**.

(26) Manipulator arm **112** may be a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system, such as any of manipulator arms **112-1** through **112-4** of surgical system **100**. Any suitable surgical instrument, such as surgical instrument **204**, may be physically coupled to manipulator arm **112** in any suitable way.

(27) User control mechanism **202** may be part of user control system **104** of surgical system **100**. For example, user control mechanism **202** may include or be included in a set of master controls of user control system **104**. In certain examples, for instance, user control mechanism **202** may be a portion of a set of master controls configured to be manipulated by a surgeon to control movement

of surgical instruments. For example, user control mechanism **202** may be configured to be manipulated by a hand of a surgeon to telemanipulate a surgical instrument attached to a manipulator arm, and the set of master controls may include additional controls for controlling movement of surgical instruments, such as another user control mechanism **202** configured to be manipulated by the other hand of the surgeon to telemanipulate another surgical instrument attached to another manipulator arm. Although FIG. 2 illustrates user control mechanism **202** configured to be manipulated by one hand of a surgeon, in other examples a user control mechanism may be a set of master controls that includes multiple mechanisms configured to be manipulated to control movement of surgical instruments. Hence, a user control mechanism, as used herein, may refer to a portion of a set of master controls or to an entire set of master controls.

(28) User control mechanism **202** may include a variety of mechanisms (e.g., buttons, finger loops, levers, pivot points, etc.) configured to receive a wide variety of hand, wrist, and finger movements by a surgeon to control movement of surgical instruments. Accordingly, a surgeon may manipulate user control mechanism **202** in various ways and with multiple degrees of freedom in order to telemanipulate surgical instrument **204** that is coupled to user control mechanism **202** by way of manipulator arm **112** and control system **200**.

(29) Additionally, user control mechanism **202** includes a user input mechanism **206** by which the surgeon may provide input to indicate various modes of operation. User input mechanism **206** may be implemented as a button situated on user control mechanism **202**, as illustrated. Alternatively or additionally, user input mechanism **206** may be implemented as any type of input mechanism, such as a switch, a toggle input, a directional pad, a joystick, etc. Further, while user input mechanism **206** is shown as a part of user control mechanism **202** (e.g., situated on user control mechanism **202**), user input mechanism **206** may alternatively or additionally include input mechanisms separate from user control mechanism **202**, such as a foot pedal, a voice input mechanism, or any other suitable input mechanism.

(30) In certain implementations, user input mechanism **206** may include a binary input mechanism having exactly two different mechanical positions (e.g., on and off positions, actuated and non-actuated positions, etc.) that are mapped to discrete input options and that may be selected by user actuation and/or de-actuation of user input mechanism **206**. For example, user input mechanism **206** may include a button (e.g., a spring-loaded button), a switch (e.g., a spring-loaded switch), a slider (e.g., a spring-loaded slider), a pedal (e.g., a spring-loaded pedal), or the like. Such an input mechanism may facilitate discrete and momentary input to select from two binary options (e.g., two mechanical positions).

(31) User input mechanism **206** may be associated with user control mechanism **202** in any suitable way. For example, user input mechanism **206** may be disposed on user control mechanism **202** such that user input mechanism **206** is readily accessible by a surgeon using user control mechanism **202** to telemanipulate surgical instrument **204**. As an alternative example, user input mechanism **206** may be associated with user control mechanism **202** by virtue of both user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** being components of the same computer-assisted surgical system. For instance, user input mechanism **206** may be a foot pedal that may be actuated and de-actuated by a user of the computer-assisted surgical system.

(32) Control system **200** is configured to receive information from user control mechanism **202**. For example, control system **200** may receive information regarding position, movement, etc. of user control mechanism **202** and/or information regarding user interaction with user control mechanism **202**. Based on such information, control system **200** may track the position, movement, and/or other attributes of user control mechanism **202**.

(33) Control system **200** may also receive information from manipulator arm **112**, such as information regarding movement, pressure, and/or other attributes of manipulator arm **112**. In certain examples and/or modes of operation, control system **200** may process the information received from manipulator arm **112** and provide corresponding information and/or signals to user

control mechanism **202** to provide feedback (e.g., haptic feedback) to the surgeon.

(34) When operating in certain operating modes (e.g., a normal mode of operation), control system **200** may process the information received from user control mechanism **202** to generate information and/or signals to send to manipulator arm **112** to cause manipulator arm **112** and/or surgical instrument **204** to operate in accordance with the information received from user control mechanism **202**. In this or a similar manner, control system **200** may translate attributes of user control mechanism **202** into corresponding operations of manipulator arm **112** and surgical instrument **204**, such as by translating movement of user control mechanism **202** into corresponding movement of manipulator arm **112** and surgical instrument **204**. In this way, control system **200** couples user control mechanism **202** to manipulator arm **112** such that a surgeon may telemanipulate surgical instrument **204** attached to manipulator arm **112** using user control mechanism **202**.

(35) When operating in certain operating modes, control system **200** may output different information to manipulator arm **112** and/or may output information to other components of the surgical system (e.g., one or more display components). When operating in some operating modes, control system **200** may output no information to manipulator arm **112**, such as when operating in a clutch mode of operation in which control system **200** decouples user control mechanism **202** from controlling movement of manipulator arm **112** and surgical instrument **204**. Examples of operating modes of surgical system **100** will be described in further detail below.

(36) Control system **200** is also configured to receive information from user input mechanism **206**. For example, control system **200** may receive information indicating a type of input received by way of user input mechanism **206**. For example, if user input mechanism **206** is a button, the type of input from user input mechanism **206** may include a press of the button, a release of the button, a press and hold of the button, etc. Alternatively or additionally, the type of input received by way of user input mechanism **206** may include any suitable movement, actuation, and/or de-actuation of user input mechanism **206**. The information regarding the type of input from user input mechanism **206** may indicate one input or more than one input received via user input mechanism **206**, such as a single press, a single release, a press and a release, a double-press, etc. Control system **200** may receive or generate information indicating one or more times associated with input(s) received by way of user input mechanism **206**, such as a timestamp indicating a time when an input was received.

(37) Control system **200** includes a function selection system **208**. Control system **200** may provide information to function selection system **208** for use by function selection system **208** to select (e.g., determine and activate) a desired function of the computer-assisted surgical system based on input received via user input mechanism **206** and information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** (e.g., contextual information).

(38) FIG. 3 illustrates an exemplary function selection system **208** that may be configured to select a function of a computer-assisted surgical system to be performed. Function selection system **208** may be a part of control system **200** as in FIG. 2. Alternatively, function selection system **208** may be a separate system communicatively coupled to control system **200**.

(39) As shown in FIG. 3, function selection system **208** may include a storage facility **302**, a processing facility **304**, and operation modes **308** (operation modes **308-1** through **308-N**). Storage facility **302** and processing facility **304** may be selectively and communicatively coupled to one another. Storage facility **302** and processing facility **304** may each include or be implemented by hardware and/or software components (e.g., processors, memories, communication interfaces, instructions stored in memory for execution by the processors, etc.). For example, storage facility **302** and processing facility **304** may be implemented by any component(s) of a computer-assisted surgical system.

(40) Storage facility **302** may maintain (e.g., store) executable data used by processing facility **304** to perform any of the operations described herein. For example, storage facility **302** may store

instructions **306** that may be executed by processing facility **304** to perform any of the operations described herein. Instructions **306** may be implemented by any suitable application, software, code, and/or other executable data instance. Storage facility **302** may also maintain any data received, generated, managed, used, and/or transmitted by processing facility **304**.

(41) Processing facility **304** may be configured to perform (e.g., execute instructions **306** stored in storage facility **302** to perform) various operations associated with selecting functions of a computer-assisted surgical system such as surgical system **100** to be performed. For example, processing facility **304** may process input and information received by function selection system **208** and select a function to be performed based on the input and information. Once processing facility **304** selects a function, function selection system **208** may notify control system **200** of the selected function. Control system **200** may respond by performing the selected function.

(42) A function of a computer-assisted surgical system may include any function that may be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system. In certain examples, a function may include an activation or a deactivation of a mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system. In other examples, a function may include any other function associated with a mode of operation, such as a function that may be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system when operating in a particular mode of operation.

(43) In certain examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to select an operation mode from among various available operation modes **308** for a computer-assisted surgical system such as surgical system **100**. For example, function selection system **208** may be configured to select from a first operation mode **308-1**, a second operation mode **308-2**, a third operation mode **308-3**, and an nth operation mode **308-N**. In certain examples, operation modes **308** may include a normal mode of operation, a clutch mode of operation, a measurement mode of operation, various camera and/or visual modes of operation (e.g., different types of fluorescence visualization modes of operation), different types of movement modes of operation, etc.

(44) As an example, first operation mode **308-1** may be a normal operation mode in which control system **200** is configured to translate input received via user control mechanism **202** to operations of manipulator arm **112** in a manner that allows a surgeon to telemanipulate surgical instrument **204**. When the normal operation mode is activated, control system **200** may couple or otherwise engage user control mechanism **202** with manipulator arm **112** such that manipulations of user control mechanism **202** are translated into operations of manipulator arm **112** and surgical instrument **204**. Hence, when the normal operation mode is activated, as a surgeon moves his or her fingers, wrists, and hands via master controls, control system **200** may control one or more manipulator arms **112** to telemanipulate one or more surgical instruments in a corresponding manner.

(45) Second operation mode **308-2** may be, for example, a clutch operation mode in which control system **200** may decouple user control mechanism **202** from manipulator arm **112** in a manner that allows the surgeon to move user control mechanism **202** without causing corresponding movement of manipulator arm **112** or surgical instrument **204**. For example, the surgeon may reposition his or her hands and/or master controls without moving the surgical instruments and may do so when the clutch mode of operation is activated.

(46) Third operation mode **308-3** may be, for example, a measurement operation mode in which control system **200** may couple user control mechanism **202** to manipulator arm **112** in a manner that allows the surgeon to control surgical instrument **204** as in the normal mode of operation. Control system **200** may also allow the surgeon to measure distances in a surgical area using surgical instrument **204** (and optionally one or more other surgical instruments) when the measurement mode of operation is activated. For example, control system **200** may receive input specifying an indication of a starting point and an indication of an ending point and determine and provide a distance between the ending point and the starting point. Alternatively or additionally, control system **200** may receive input specifying an indication of a starting point and determine and

provide a distance from the starting point to a current position of surgical instrument **204** as surgical instrument **204** is moved. For example, the indication of the starting point may be a point at which the measurement mode is activated by control system **200**. Once control system **200** has activated the measurement mode of operation, the surgeon may be provided a visual indicator of distance from the starting point as the surgeon moves surgical instrument **204** via user control mechanism **202**. In some examples, the surgeon may provide input indicating an ending point. In some examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to automatically deactivate the measurement mode of operation in response to detecting the indication of the ending point. Surgical system **100** may be configured to provide the distance measurement between the starting point and ending point as output in any suitable way (e.g., visually of a display screen) and/or store data representative of the distance measurement to a data storage.

(47) Function selection system **208** may be configured to determine and activate an operation mode of control system **200**. To this end, function selection system **208** may detect input received by way of user input mechanism **206** and select an operation mode based on information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202**.

(48) For example, function selection system **208** may detect an input received by way of user input mechanism **206**. Based on detecting the input, function selection system **208** may determine information associated with user input mechanism **206**. For example, information associated with user input mechanism **206** may include a type of input received via user input mechanism **206**, such as an actuation or de-actuation of user input mechanism **206**. Information associated with user input mechanism **206** may also include a timestamp, such as a time when the input was received.

(49) Based on detecting the input, function selection system **208** may also determine information associated with user control mechanism **202**. Information associated with user control mechanism **202** may provide additional context of the input and may be used by function selection system **208** to select an operation mode. For example, information associated with user control mechanism **202** may include a position of user control mechanism **202**, a movement of user control mechanism **202**, a velocity of user control mechanism **202**, etc. Function selection system **208** may determine information associated with user control mechanism **202** at any suitable time, including upon detecting receipt of input via user input mechanism **206**, in response to one or more other events, and/or periodically at any suitable sampling rate.

(50) Function selection system **208** may compare information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** to a set of defined criteria to determine an operation mode to be selected. The set of defined criteria may include any suitable set of criteria, such as a threshold distance, a threshold velocity, a threshold time, etc. The set of defined criteria may be defined in any suitable way (e.g., in advance of operation of control system **200**) and as may suit a particular implementation. Examples of defined criteria are described herein.

(51) Based on comparing the information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** to a set of defined criteria, function selection system **208** may determine and activate one or more operation modes of control system **200**. Illustrative examples of how function selection system **208** may be configured to select operation modes based on input received by way of user input mechanism **206** and on comparison of information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** to a set of defined criteria are described herein.

(52) In certain implementations, user input mechanism **206** may be configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which user control mechanism **202** is decoupled from controlling a surgical instrument. The decoupling may decouple a coupling of user control mechanism **202** to the surgical instrument that exists when control system **200** operates in a normal mode of operation in which user control mechanism **202** may be manipulated to cause the surgical instrument to move correspondingly. The decoupling may be performed in any suitable way, including by physically, logically, or communicatively decoupling user control mechanism **202** from the manipulator arm **112** to which the surgical instrument is attached. When the clutch

mode of operation is activated, control system **200** may decouple user control mechanism **202** from controlling the surgical instrument. When the clutch mode of operation is deactivated, control system **200** may couple user control mechanism **202** for controlling the surgical instrument.

(53) Function selection system **208** may be configured to activate and deactivate the clutch mode of operation based on input received by way of user input mechanism **206**. In certain examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to automatically and/or instantaneously activate the clutch operation mode when a surgeon actuates (e.g., presses) user input mechanism **206**. In certain alternative examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to activate the clutch operation mode when a surgeon actuates (e.g., presses) and holds user input mechanism **206** at least a defined amount of time. In other alternative examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to activate the clutch operation mode when a surgeon actuates (e.g., presses) and holds user input mechanism and moves user control mechanism **202** at least a defined threshold distance while user input mechanism **206** is actuated.

(54) Function selection system **208** may be configured to deactivate the clutch mode of operation based on input received by way of user input mechanism **206**. In certain examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to automatically and/or instantaneously deactivate the clutch operation mode when the surgeon de-actuates (e.g., releases) user input mechanism **206**, such as when the surgeon releases user input mechanism **206** to end an actuation (e.g., a press and hold) of user input mechanism **206**.

(55) In addition to user input mechanism **206** being configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation, user input mechanism **206** may be configured to facilitate performance of a function associated with another mode of operation. The function may be any function that may be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system. For example, the function may include an activation or deactivation of another mode of operation, such as a measurement mode of operation or a particular visualization mode of operation, for example. As another example, the function may be a function that is performed when the computer-assisted surgical system is operating in another particular mode of operation, such as a measurement sampling function that is performed when operating in the measurement mode of operation. In certain examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to perform a function associated with another mode of operation (e.g., activating the mode of operation or performing a function within an active mode of operation) when a surgeon quickly (e.g., in less time than a predefined time threshold) actuates and de-actuates user input mechanism **206** while keeping user control mechanism **202** stationary (e.g., by not moving user control mechanism **202** more than a predefined distance threshold).

(56) In certain examples, a held actuation of user input mechanism **206** may indicate that a surgeon intends to operate in the clutch mode of operation, and a quick actuation and de-actuation of user input mechanism **206** may indicate that the surgeon intends to invoke a function associated with another mode of operation, such as a function of the measurement mode of operation. In such examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to perform the function associated with the other operation mode when user input mechanism **206** is actuated and de-actuated quickly (e.g., in less time than a predefined time threshold) and user control mechanism **202** is stationary (e.g., is not moved more than a predefined distance threshold) when user input mechanism **206** is actuated and de-actuated.

(57) In order to determine whether to perform the function associated with another mode of operation in response to input received by way of user input mechanism **206**, function selection system **208** may determine contextual information associated with the input received by way of user input mechanism **206** and compare the information to a set of defined criteria. Based on the comparing, function selection system **208** may determine whether to perform the function. By determining and using contextual information associated with the input to determine whether to perform the function, function selection system **208** may ascertain the intent of a surgeon in

providing input via user input mechanism **206** and in a manner that may allow the surgeon to intuitively and accurately choose, via the same user input mechanism **206** to which multiple, layered functions are mapped, one or more functions to be performed by the computer-assisted surgical system.

(58) Function selection system **208** may determine an intended function by comparing the input and the associated information with the set of defined criteria. For example, if a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is configured to invoke a function of the measurement operation mode and a press and hold of user input mechanism **206** is configured to activate the clutch operation mode, function selection system **208** may determine, based on information associated with input received via user input mechanism **206**, whether a detected press and release of user input mechanism **206** is intended as a quick press and release to invoke the function of the measurement operation mode or a press, hold, and release intended to activate the clutch operation mode.

(59) For example, in some implementations, function selection system **208** may detect input via user input mechanism **206** and determine a type of input detected. If the input is a press of user input mechanism **206**, function selection system **208** may determine a timestamp of the press, as well as a position and a velocity of user control mechanism **202** at the time of the press. If the input is a release of user input mechanism **206**, function selection system **208** may determine a timestamp of the release, as well as a position and a velocity of user control mechanism **202** at the time of the release.

(60) When a press and a release of user input mechanism **206** are detected, function selection system **208** may compare the timestamp, position, and velocity at the time of the release with the timestamp, position, and velocity at the time of the press to determine whether the surgeon intended a quick press of user input mechanism **206**. If the difference between the timestamps is greater than a defined threshold time, function selection system **208** may determine that the surgeon did not intend a quick press and may not invoke a function mapped to a quick press. Additionally or alternatively, if the difference between the positions is greater than a defined threshold distance, function selection system **208** may determine that the surgeon did not intend a quick press and may not invoke a function mapped to a quick press. Additionally or alternatively, if one of the velocities is greater than a defined threshold velocity and/or a velocity at a time between the press and the release is greater than the defined threshold velocity, function selection system **208** may determine that the surgeon did not intend a quick press and may not invoke a function mapped to a quick press.

(61) Conversely, function selection system **208** may invoke the function mapped to the quick press if the information satisfies the set of defined criteria, determining that the satisfaction of the set of defined criteria indicates that the surgeon intended a quick press of user input mechanism **206**. For example, if the difference between the timestamps is less than the defined threshold time, the difference between the positions is less than the defined threshold distance, and the velocities (and any detected intervening velocities) are each less than the defined threshold velocity, function selection system **208** may determine that the surgeon intended a quick press and release and may perform the function associated with another operation mode.

(62) In some embodiments, comparing information associated with user input mechanism **206** and user control mechanism **202** may enable function selection system **208** to determine inadvertent interactions with user input mechanism **206**. For example, if a time difference between a press of user input mechanism **206** and a release of user input mechanism **206** is less than a threshold time, but a velocity of user control mechanism **202** at the time of the press and/or the time of the release is greater than a threshold velocity, function selection system **208** may determine that the surgeon inadvertently pressed and released user input mechanism **206** quickly, rather than intended to invoke a function mapped to a quick press and release of user input mechanism.

(63) While the foregoing example describes invoking a function based on a quick press and release

of user input mechanism **206**, function selection system **208** may be configured to selectively invoke a function mapped to user input mechanism **206** based on any other suitable input received by user input mechanism **206** that can be differentiated, using contextual information, from input received by way of user input mechanism **206** that is configured to invoke other functionality, such as activation and/or deactivation of a clutch mode of operation.

(64) In some examples, function selection system **208** may be configured to allow a surgeon to provide different inputs, by way of user input mechanism **206**, to choose various functions to be performed. For example, system **208** may be configured to detect various inputs received by way of user input mechanism **206** and to select, based on the received inputs, one or more operation modes, from among a set of operation modes, to be activated. For example, an actuation and hold of user input mechanism **206** may activate a clutch mode of operation, while different length presses of user input mechanism **206** may activate different operation modes. Additionally or alternatively, quick presses of user input mechanism **206** may cycle through activation of different operation modes. Additionally or alternatively, a different number of successive quick presses of user input mechanism **206** (e.g., a double click) may activate different operation modes. This may allow additional functionality (e.g., a third layer of functionality) to be layered on user input mechanism **206**.

(65) Functionality may be mapped to user input mechanism **206** based on any suitable context of a computer-assisted surgical system. In some examples, contextual information may include a current mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system. For example, if control system **200** is currently operating in a normal mode of operation and a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected, function selection system **208** may perform a function mapped to a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** in relation to the normal mode of operation, such as an activation of a measurement mode of operation, a visualization mode of operation, or another mode of operation. As another example, if the current operating mode is the measurement mode of operation when a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected, function selection system **208** may perform a function mapped to a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** in relation to the measurement mode of operation, such as a measurement sampling function, a deactivation of the measurement mode of operation, or an activation of the normal mode of operation.

(66) As another example, control system **200** may be operating in a first visual operation mode in which user control mechanism **202** is coupled to and configured to telemanipulate an imaging device (e.g., an endoscope) that captures imagery of a surgical scene that is displayed (e.g., in a stereoscopic viewer of user control system **104** of surgical system **100**). Based on the current operating mode being the first visual operation mode and/or an imaging device being coupled to control mechanism **202**, function selection system **208** may activate a second visual operation mode if a surgeon quickly presses user input mechanism **206** when control system **200** is operating in the first visual mode of operation. For example, function selection system **208** may activate a second visual operation mode such as a fluorescence imagery viewing mode in which surgical system **100** displays images of a surgical scene that are augmented using fluorescence illumination (e.g., fluorescence imagery received via a fluoroscope).

(67) FIG. 3 illustrates a set of functions **610** (e.g., functions **610-1** through **610-N**) associated with operation modes **608** of a computer-assisted surgical system. Function **310-1** may be any function associated with first mode of operation **308-1**, such as an activation of first mode of operation **308-1**, a deactivation of first mode of operation **308-1**, or any function that may be performed when first mode of operation **308-1** is active. Function **310-2** may similarly be any function of second mode of operation **308-2**, and so forth. For a measurement operation mode, for example, a function associated with the measurement operation mode may include an activation of the measurement operation mode, a deactivation of the measurement mode of operation, a measurement sampling performed when the measurement mode of operation is active, or the like.

(68) Function selection system **208** may be configured to select a function to perform in response to a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** based at least in part on a current mode of operation of a control system **200**. For example, if a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected when a measurement mode of operation is active, function selection system **208** may perform a measurement sampling function of the measurement mode of operation. As another example, if a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected when a visualization mode of operation is active (e.g., when telemanipulation of an imaging device is active), function selection system **208** may activate perform a visualization function such as activating a particular visualization mode of operation like a fluorescence enhanced visualization mode of operation. These examples are illustrative only. Selection of a function to perform in response to a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** may be based on any suitable context of a computer-assisted surgical system.

(69) As mentioned, in certain implementations, an actuation of user input mechanism **206** may be configured to automatically activate a clutch mode of operation of a computer-assisted surgical system. In some examples, this may be performed globally regardless of how user input mechanisms **206** is actuated or of context associated with the actuation. Similarly, a de-actuation of user input mechanism **206** may be configured to automatically deactivate the clutch mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system. In such implementations, certain functionality of the computer-assisted surgical system may be layered on top of the activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation by being mapped to a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** that satisfies a set of predefined criteria, such as any of the exemplary criteria described herein. Thus, when a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** that satisfies a set of predefined criteria is detected, in addition to activating and deactivating the clutch mode of operation, function selection system **208** may perform one or more functions that are mapped to the quick press and release of user input mechanism **206**.

(70) The automatic activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation may provide one or more benefits to a function that is performed when a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected, and the function may assume that the clutch mode of operation is active when the function is invoked. For example, the automatic activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation may ensure that the surgical instrument **204** is not inadvertently moved when the function is performed, which may benefit the function. To illustrate, the function may include a measurement sampling during which it is desirable for the surgical instrument to not be inadvertently moved.

(71) Because activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation is mapped to user input mechanism **206** associated with control mechanism **202** that may be manipulated by a single hand of an operation, activation and deactivation of the clutch mode of operation may be applied specifically to (e.g., only to) the surgical instrument **204** connected to control mechanism **202** associated with user input mechanism **206**. In addition, one or more additional functions that are mapped to user input mechanism **206** associated with control mechanism **202** may be specific to the surgical instrument **204** connected to control mechanism **202** associated with user input mechanism **206**. Moreover, any context that is considered for selecting a function to invoke when a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected may be specific to that user input mechanism **206**, the control mechanism **202** associated with the user input mechanism **206**, and/or the surgical instrument **204** connected to the control mechanism **202** (e.g., which surgical instrument or type of surgical instrument is connected).

(72) While the foregoing examples describe illustrative implementations for selectively activating and deactivating a clutch mode of operation and selectively performing a function associated with another mode of operation (e.g., a measurement mode of operation, a fluorescence visualization mode of operation, etc.) based on user input received by way of user input mechanism **206**, function selection system **208** may be configured differently in other examples. For example, the

specific inputs for activating a clutch mode of operation and selectively performing a function associated with another mode of operation may be reversed. For instance, the clutch mode of operation may be activated on a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206**, while a function associated with a different mode of operation may be activated by pressing and holding user input mechanism **206**.

(73) While in certain implementations an actuation of user input mechanism **206** may be configured to automatically activate a clutch mode of operation of a computer-assisted surgical system, in alternative implementations, function selection system **208** may be configured to selectively activate the clutch mode of operation based on contextual information associated with the actuation of user input mechanism **206**. For example, if a quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** is detected, function selection system **208** may perform a function mapped to the quick press and release of user input mechanism **206** and may abstain from activating the clutch mode of operation. In certain examples, the function may include activating a mode of operation other than the clutch mode of operation.

(74) FIG. **4** illustrates an exemplary method **400** for selectively performing a function of a computer-assisted surgical system. While FIG. **4** illustrates exemplary operations according to one embodiment, other embodiments may omit, add to, reorder, and/or modify any of the operations shown in FIG. **4**. One or more of the operations shown in FIG. **4** may be performed by function selection system **208**, any components included therein, and/or any implementation thereof.

(75) In operation **402**, a function selection system detects input received by way of a user input mechanism (e.g., an actuation and a de-actuation of the user input mechanism) configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which a user control mechanism is decoupled from controlling a surgical instrument. Operation **402** may be performed in any of the ways described herein.

(76) In operation **404**, the function selection system determines, based on the detecting of the input, information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism. Information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism may include any contextual information, examples of which have been described herein. Operation **404** may be performed in any of the ways described herein.

(77) In operation **406**, the function selection system compares the information with a set of defined criteria. Operation **406** may be performed in any of the ways described herein.

(78) In operation **408**, the function selection system performs, when the information satisfies the set of defined criteria, a function associated with a different mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system. Operation **408** may be performed in any of the ways described herein.

(79) FIG. **5** illustrates an exemplary method **500** for selectively performing layered functions of a computer-assisted surgical system. While FIG. **5** illustrates exemplary operations according to one embodiment, other embodiments may omit, add to, reorder, and/or modify any of the operations shown in FIG. **5**. One or more of the operations shown in FIG. **5** may be performed by function selection system **208**, any components included therein, and/or any implementation thereof.

(80) In exemplary method **500**, the function selection system is configured to activate a clutch mode of operation (“clutch mode”) upon detecting input indicating an actuation of a user input mechanism and to deactivate clutch mode upon detecting input indicating a de-actuation of the user input mechanism. Thus, any actuation of the user input mechanism activates clutch mode, and any de-actuation of the user input mechanism deactivates clutch mode. The function selection system determines upon de-actuation of the user input mechanism whether information associated with the inputs satisfies a set of defined criteria. If the set of defined criteria is determined to be satisfied, the function selection system activates a different operation mode (e.g., a measurement mode of operation, an augmented display mode of operation, etc.).

(81) In operation **502**, a function selection system determines information associated with a user input mechanism and a user control mechanism. In some examples, the function selection system

may periodically (e.g., continually) sample to determine information such as whether input has been received via the user input mechanism, a position of the user control mechanism, and a velocity of the user control mechanism.

(82) In operation **504**, the function selection system determines whether a state of the user input mechanism has changed. For example, if the user input mechanism is a button, function selection system may determine whether the button has changed from pressed to released or vice versa. If the state of the user input mechanism has not changed, the function selection system may perform operation **506**.

(83) In operation **506**, the function selection system computes a distance between a current position of the user control mechanism and an initial position of the user control mechanism that has been previously stored by the function selection system.

(84) In operation **508**, the function selection system compares the computed distance and determined velocity to a set of defined criteria. For example, the computed distance may be compared to a threshold distance and a determined velocity (e.g., a velocity determined in operation **502**) may be compared to a threshold velocity. If the criteria are satisfied, the function selection system may return to operation **502** to continue sampling for information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism. If the criteria are not satisfied, for example a threshold is exceeded, an invalid click flag may be set in operation **514**. An invalid click flag may be used to indicate that an actuation and de-actuation of the user input mechanism is not indicative of an intention to activate the different operation mode. For example, if a surgeon moves the user control mechanism beyond a threshold distance or faster than a threshold velocity, either while the user input mechanism is actuated or de-actuated, the function selection system may determine that the surgeon is not intending a quick press of the user input mechanism and thus set the invalid click flag. The invalid click flag may be included as contextual information associated with the user input mechanism.

(85) Returning to operation **504**, if the state of the user input mechanism is determined to have changed, the function selection system may perform operation **510**. In operation **510**, the function selection system detects a type of input of the user input mechanism. If the user input mechanism has been actuated (i.e., an actuated type input), the function selection system performs operation **516**.

(86) In operation **516**, the function selection system stores a position of the user control mechanism and a timestamp of the received input. The function selection system may determine the position and the timestamp as the initial position and initial timestamp in any suitable way, including by using the position and timestamp last sampled in operation **502** or by sampling the position and time in response to detecting that the state of the user input mechanism changed in operation **504** or determining that the user input mechanism is actuated in operation **506**. The stored position and timestamp may be used to compute distances, times, and velocities of the user control mechanism.

(87) In operation **520**, the function selection system clears the invalid click flag. As the received input is a new actuation of the user input mechanism, the function selection system may presume the click is valid until determined otherwise and may thus clear the invalid click flag to purge any determination of an invalid click from a previous actuation of the user input mechanism.

(88) In operation **524**, the function selection system activates clutch mode. As described above, in this example, the function selection system may activate clutch mode in response to any actuation of the user input mechanism. In this way, a surgeon may operate the surgical system in clutch mode upon actuation of the user input mechanism. After activating clutch mode in operation **524**, the function selection system returns to operation **502** to continue sampling of the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism.

(89) Returning to operation **510**, if the state change of the user input mechanism is a de-actuation, the function selection system may deactivate clutch mode in operation **512**. As described above, in this example, the function selection system may deactivate clutch mode in response to any de-

actuation of the user input mechanism. In this way, a surgeon may cease to operate the surgical system in clutch mode upon de-actuation of the user input mechanism.

(90) Upon deactivation of clutch mode, the function selection system may perform operation **518** in which the function selection system may compute a time between a timestamp of the de-actuation of clutch mode and the initial timestamp (e.g., an initial timestamp stored in operation **516** when the user input mechanism was actuated). The function selection system may also compute a distance between a current position of the user control mechanism and the stored initial position of the user control mechanism (e.g., an initial position stored in operation **516** when the user input mechanism was actuated).

(91) In operation **522**, the function selection system compares the computed distance with a threshold distance. The threshold distance in operation **522** may be the same or different from the threshold distance in operation **508**. If the computed distance is more than (or greater than or equal to) the threshold distance, the function selection system may determine that the surgeon intended the clutch mode operation or that the actuation of the user input mechanism was inadvertent. The function selection system then returns to operation **502** to continue sampling. If the computed distance satisfies the defined criteria (e.g., is less than the threshold distance, is less than or equal to the threshold distance, etc.), the function selection system performs operation **526**.

(92) In operation **526**, the function selection system compares the computed time with a threshold time. If the computed time is more than (or greater than or equal to) the threshold time, the function selection system may determine that the surgeon intended the clutch mode operation. The function selection system then returns to operation **502** to continue sampling. If the computed time satisfies the defined criteria (e.g., is less than the threshold time, is less than or equal to the threshold time, etc.), the function selection system performs operation **528**.

(93) In operation **528**, the function selection system checks whether the invalid click flag is set. If the invalid click flag had been set previously and not cleared, it may indicate that the actuation of the user input mechanism was inadvertent. For example, the surgeon may actuate the user input mechanism, move the user control mechanism in a manner that returns the user control mechanism to a position within the threshold distance of the initial position in a time that is within the threshold time of the initial time. In such a case, the distance traveled by and/or the velocity of the user control mechanism between the actuation and the de-actuation would exceed the threshold distance or the threshold velocity (operation **508**) such that the invalid click flag would have been set (operation **514**). If the invalid click flag is set, the function selection system may determine that the actuation was inadvertent or that the surgeon did not intend to activate the different mode of operation and may return to operation **502**. If the invalid click flag is not set, the function selection system may determine that the surgeon intended to perform a layered function associated with the different mode of operation, and the function selection system performs the layered function associated with the different mode of operation in operation **530**. Operation **530** may be performed in any of the ways described herein.

(94) In certain examples, a function selection system may be configured to perform one or more of the operations described herein at a servo rate (of a faster rate) of the user control mechanism to provide a certain level of temporal resolution and/or trajectory monitoring of small deviations of the user control mechanism. In other examples, an operation mode selection system may be configured to perform one or more of the operations described herein at any suitable rate.

(95) In certain examples, a function selection system may be configured to use threshold values such as a distance threshold of two millimeters, a velocity threshold of two millimeters per second, and a time threshold of 0.5 seconds. Such threshold values may be included, in any suitable way, in a defined set of criteria and used by the operation mode selection system for comparisons of inputs and information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism to determine when to activate or not activate a mode of operation. Any other suitable threshold values may be used in other examples.

(96) In certain embodiments, one or more of the systems, components, and/or processes described herein may be implemented and/or performed by one or more appropriately configured computing devices. To this end, one or more of the systems and/or components described above may include or be implemented by any computer hardware and/or computer-implemented instructions (e.g., software) embodied on at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein. In particular, system components may be implemented on one physical computing device or may be implemented on more than one physical computing device. Accordingly, system components may include any number of computing devices, and may employ any of a number of computer operating systems.

(97) In certain embodiments, one or more of the processes described herein may be implemented at least in part as instructions embodied in a non-transitory computer-readable medium and executable by one or more computing devices. In general, a processor (e.g., a microprocessor) receives instructions, from a non-transitory computer-readable medium, (e.g., a memory, etc.), and executes those instructions, thereby performing one or more processes, including one or more of the processes described herein. Such instructions may be stored and/or transmitted using any of a variety of known computer-readable media.

(98) A computer-readable medium (also referred to as a processor-readable medium) includes any non-transitory medium that participates in providing data (e.g., instructions) that may be read by a computer (e.g., by a processor of a computer). Such a medium may take many forms, including, but not limited to, non-volatile media, and/or volatile media. Non-volatile media may include, for example, optical or magnetic disks and other persistent memory. Volatile media may include, for example, dynamic random access memory (“DRAM”), which typically constitutes a main memory. Common forms of computer-readable media include, for example, a disk, hard disk, magnetic tape, any other magnetic medium, a compact disc read-only memory (“CD-ROM”), a digital video disc (“DVD”), any other optical medium, random access memory (“RAM”), programmable read-only memory (“PROM”), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (“EPROM”), FLASH-EEPROM, any other memory chip or cartridge, or any other tangible medium from which a computer can read.

(99) FIG. 6 illustrates an exemplary computing device **600** that may be specifically configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein. As shown in FIG. 6, computing device **600** may include a communication interface **602**, a processor **604**, a storage device **606**, and an input/output (“I/O”) module **608** communicatively connected via a communication infrastructure **610**. While an exemplary computing device **600** is shown in FIG. 6, the components illustrated in FIG. 6 are not intended to be limiting. Additional or alternative components may be used in other embodiments. Components of computing device **600** shown in FIG. 6 will now be described in additional detail.

(100) Communication interface **602** may be configured to communicate with one or more computing devices. Examples of communication interface **602** include, without limitation, a wired network interface (such as a network interface card), a wireless network interface (such as a wireless network interface card), a modem, an audio/video connection, and any other suitable interface.

(101) Processor **604** generally represents any type or form of processing unit capable of processing data or interpreting, executing, and/or directing execution of one or more of the instructions, processes, and/or operations described herein. Processor **604** may direct execution of operations in accordance with one or more applications **612** or other computer-executable instructions such as may be stored in storage device **606** or another computer-readable medium.

(102) Storage device **606** may include one or more data storage media, devices, or configurations and may employ any type, form, and combination of data storage media and/or device. For example, storage device **606** may include, but is not limited to, a hard drive, network drive, flash drive, magnetic disc, optical disc, RAM, dynamic RAM, other non-volatile and/or volatile data

storage units, or a combination or sub-combination thereof. Electronic data, including data described herein, may be temporarily and/or permanently stored in storage device **606**. For example, data representative of one or more executable applications **612** configured to direct processor **604** to perform any of the operations described herein may be stored within storage device **606**. In some examples, data may be arranged in one or more databases residing within storage device **606**.

(103) I/O module **608** may include one or more I/O modules configured to receive user input and provide user output. One or more I/O modules may be used to receive input for a single virtual reality experience. I/O module **608** may include any hardware, firmware, software, or combination thereof supportive of input and output capabilities. For example, I/O module **608** may include hardware and/or software for capturing user input, including, but not limited to, a keyboard or keypad, a touchscreen component (e.g., touchscreen display), a receiver (e.g., an RF or infrared receiver), motion sensors, and/or one or more input buttons.

(104) I/O module **608** may include one or more devices for presenting output to a user, including, but not limited to, a graphics engine, a display (e.g., a display screen), one or more output drivers (e.g., display drivers), one or more audio speakers, and one or more audio drivers. In certain embodiments, I/O module **608** is configured to provide graphical data to a display for presentation to a user. The graphical data may be representative of one or more graphical user interfaces and/or any other graphical content as may serve a particular implementation.

(105) In the preceding description, various exemplary embodiments have been described with reference to the accompanying drawings. It will, however, be evident that various modifications and changes may be made thereto, and additional embodiments may be implemented, without departing from the scope of the invention as set forth in the claims that follow. For example, certain features of one embodiment described herein may be combined with or substituted for features of another embodiment described herein. The description and drawings are accordingly to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense.

Claims

1. A system comprising: a memory storing instructions; a processor communicatively coupled to the memory and configured to execute the instructions to: activate a first mode of operation in which movement of a user control mechanism is translated to movement of a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system; receive, during the first mode of operation, a first user input by way of a user input mechanism associated with the user control mechanism; activate, based on the first user input, a second mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is repositionable without causing the surgical instrument to move; receive, during the first mode of operation, a second user input by way of the user input mechanism, wherein the second user input is different from the first user input; and activate, based on the second user input, a function associated with a third mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system, the third mode of operation different from the first and second modes of operation.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the processor is further configured to differentiate the first user input from the second user input by: determining information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism; and comparing the information to a set of defined criteria.
3. The system of claim 2, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold distance; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a movement of the user control mechanism while the user input mechanism is actuated satisfies the defined threshold distance.
4. The system of claim 2, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold time; the information associated with the user control mechanism includes a first timestamp indicating

- when the first input is received and a second timestamp indicating when the second input is received; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a time difference between the first timestamp and the second timestamp satisfies the defined threshold time.
5. The system of claim 2, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold distance; the information associated with the user control mechanism includes a first position indicating a position of the user control mechanism when the first input is received and a second position indicating a position of the user control mechanism when the second input is received; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a distance difference between the first position and the second position satisfies the defined threshold distance.
6. The system of claim 2, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold velocity; the information associated with and the user control mechanism includes information indicating a velocity of the user control mechanism; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether the velocity satisfies the defined threshold velocity.
7. The system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to automatically activate the second mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is repositionable without causing the surgical instrument to move upon an actuation of the user input mechanism and deactivate the mode of operation upon a de-actuation of the user input mechanism.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein: the third mode of operation includes a measurement mode of operation in which the surgical instrument is configured to be used to measure a distance between two points; and the function comprises at least one of an activation of the measurement mode and a measurement sampling of the measurement mode.
9. The system of claim 1, wherein the third mode of operation includes a viewing mode of operation in which a display of imagery of a surgical scene is augmented using fluorescence illumination.
10. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions that, when executed, direct at least one processor of a computing device to: detect a first input received by way of a user input mechanism associated with a user control mechanism for controlling a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system, the user input mechanism configured to facilitate activation and deactivation of a clutch mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is decoupled from controlling the surgical instrument; determine, based on the detecting of the first input, a first set of information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism; detect a second input received by way of the user input mechanism; determine, based on the detecting of the second input, a second set of information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism; compare the first set of information and the second set of information to a set of defined criteria; and perform, when the set of defined criteria is satisfied, a function associated with a different mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system.
11. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 10, wherein the instructions, when executed, further direct the at least one processor to differentiate the first user input from the second user input by: determining information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism; and comparing the information to a set of defined criteria.
12. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 11, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold distance; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a movement of the user control mechanism while the user input mechanism is actuated satisfies the defined threshold distance.
13. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 11, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold time; the information associated with the user control mechanism

includes a first timestamp indicating when the first input is received and a second timestamp indicating when the second input is received; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a time difference between the first timestamp and the second timestamp satisfies the defined threshold time.

14. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 11, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold distance; the information associated with the user control mechanism includes a first position indicating a position of the user control mechanism when the first input is received and a second position indicating a position of the user control mechanism when the second input is received; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether a distance difference between the first position and the second position satisfies the defined threshold distance.

15. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 11, wherein: the set of defined criteria comprises a defined threshold velocity; the information associated with and the user control mechanism includes information indicating a velocity of the user control mechanism; and the comparing of the information to the set of defined criteria comprises determining whether the velocity satisfies the defined threshold velocity.

16. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 10, wherein the processor is configured to automatically activate the second mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is repositionable without causing the surgical instrument to move upon an actuation of the user input mechanism and deactivate the mode of operation upon a de-actuation of the user input mechanism.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 10, wherein: the third mode of operation includes a measurement mode of operation in which the surgical instrument is configured to be used to measure a distance between two points; and the function comprises at least one of an activation of the measurement mode and a measurement sampling of the measurement mode.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 10, wherein the third mode of operation includes a viewing mode of operation in which a display of imagery of a surgical scene is augmented using fluorescence illumination.

19. A computer-implemented method comprising: activating a first mode of operation in which movement of a user control mechanism is translated to movement of a surgical instrument coupled to a manipulator arm of a computer-assisted surgical system; receiving, during the first mode of operation, a first user input by way of a user input mechanism associated with the user control mechanism; activating, based on the first user input, a second mode of operation in which the user control mechanism is repositionable without causing the surgical instrument to move; receiving, during the first mode of operation, a second user input by way of the user input mechanism, wherein the second user input is different from the first user input; and activating, based on the second user input, a function associated with a third mode of operation of the computer-assisted surgical system, the third mode of operation different from the first and second modes of operation.

20. The method of claim 19, further comprising differentiating the first user input from the second user input by: determining information associated with the user input mechanism and the user control mechanism; and comparing the information to a set of defined criteria.
